

If You Get an Offer

Estimated time needed: 3 minutes

Introduction

After a series of tough interviews, let's say you get a job offer. That's great news but you may be anxious to accept the offer and start the exciting journey. Before you can get started with the new job, you need to complete some steps.

Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to:

- Explain the steps to take if you interview and receive a job offer
- Summarize the do's and don'ts

Steps to take

If you get a job offer during your interview, you should:

- **Express gratitude and appreciation** for the offer. Thank the interviewers for their time and let them know how happy to are to be presented with the offer.
- **Clarify any questions** about the position. Ensure your understanding of the position being offered matches the expectations of the firm. In addition, the employer may initiate discussion of salary, and benefits. Don't underestimate yourself. Know your value. We will address salary negotiations in a video to follow.
- **Request written details** of the offer. You need to ensure that the offer you heard is the offer that was presented. It is acceptable to request a day or two to review the written offer prior to formal acceptance.
- **Inform other companies that you interviewing with** about the job offer. Avoid burning bridges that you may need to cross in the future.

Do's and don'ts

Here is a summary of the key do's and don'ts when you receive a job offer.

Do:

- Thank the employer for the offer.
- Get the offer in writing. You may provide initial acceptance, but do not formally accept the offer until you review the written documentation.
- Ensure both you and the employer have a common understanding of the job expectations and seek clarity as needed. There should be no disconnects.
- Understand acceptable salary ranges for the job based on the industry and demographics of the position. Do your research ahead of time.

Don't:

- Feel obligated to accept the offer on the spot. Take some time if needed to consider the offer.
- Bring up salary until the employer initiates the conversation. Be ready to negotiate, know your value, and have an acceptable salary range in mind.
- Say yes until you are 100% sure this is the job for you.



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